



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

LENT 2022

Worship in March & April

The season of Lent begins this year with Ash Wednesday on Wednesday, March 2, and concludes with the celebration of Easter on April 17. In between those two dates are 40 days, plus the 6 “free” Sundays. Sundays are “free” because every Sunday is a mini-Easter and thus they are not counted in the 40 days. For Lent this year, we will be utilizing a poem by Mary Oliver each week in addition to our scripture reading. Sometimes, a reading from another source can give more body to familiar Bible passages and help us to think about them in new ways. And, we will be bringing back singing. With the Omicron surge waning and the vaccine for the youngest among us just around the corner, we will begin masked singing on Palm Sunday. For many of us, congregational singing is an important part of worship. It allows us to participate in worship in a way that is impossible to duplicate, so we celebrate being able to worship together in this way again!

Some other things happening this Lent:

- Ash Wednesday service in March 2 at 6:30
- Lenten Devotionals are available at the church
- Soul Reset Adult Study
- Personal dignity items drive
- Look for information about each of these things in this newsletter.

Mar. 2 Ash Wednesday

“Treasures on Earth” *Matthew 6:1-6, 16-21*, “Storage” *

Mar. 6 Communion

“Change of Heart” *Mark 1:9-15*, “Wild Geese”*

Mar 13

“Gaining the World” *Mark 8:27-38*, “In Blackwater Woods”*

Mar. 20 United Methodist Women Sunday

John 2:13-25, “Where Does the Temple Begin, Where Does It End?”*

Mar 27

‘All Y’all,’ *John 3:14-21*, “Some Questions You Might Ask”*

Apr. 3

“Growing a Heart”, *Jeremiah 31:27-34* “Mindful”*

Apr. 10 Palm Sunday

“Living into Praise”, *Luke 19:28-40*, “The Poet Thinks About the Donkey”*

*poems by Mary Oliver



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Newsletter Schedule

We are trying a different thing with our newsletter. Rather than a monthly newsletter, we are trying to provide newsletters that cover a programming period. So, this newsletter comes to you as Lent begins and tells you a little about what has happened over the last two months while also letting you know what will be happening during Lent. Another newsletter will come out at the beginning of April, covering the time period of Holy Week into Easter and then through the rest of the spring. One newsletter will cover summer, and then in August, we will have a newsletter that covers the fall up to Thanksgiving. For those of you submitting information to go out in the newsletter, here is our planned schedule for this year:

- Deadline April 1, mailed April 6/7
- Deadline May 27, mailed June 2/3
- Deadline Aug. 12, mailed Aug. 19
- Deadline Nov. 11, mailed Nov. 17

And, if you miss a deadline, don't forget that the vast majority of our folks get the weekly enews, and you can always put information in that as well. We do try to make the enews shorter by having events that are 1-3 weeks away, so you are welcome to have a quick "save the date" article further out, but then provide information closer to the event.

Newcomer Class

We'll be holding an introduction and orientation class for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining on Saturday, March 26 at 9:30 a.m. You can come in person or attend via zoom; when you RSVP (becky@minnehaha.org), just let us know which way you'd like to attend.



Nice warm indoor Sunday School!

Minnehaha Plant Sale

Sponsored by the Youth of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

Order Link Available at www.minnehaha.org

All sales must be submitted by April 7th - Pick up available on May 13th & 14th

Hanging Pots - ranging from \$35-83

Geraniums, Impatients, Compact Rose, Fuscias,
Begonia, Thunbergias, Petunias, & more



Patio Pots - ranging from \$38-83

Geranium, Begonias, & Combos



Proceeds go to benefit the Minnehaha Youth Ministries
Questions? Please contact Jason Emrick @651.621.0231

Pictures are examples of the plants, not the plants you will receive.



MARCH & APRIL



SUNDAY SCHOOL

March 6, 13, & 20th: Sunday School Inside (masks required) from 10:15-11

March 27th: Intergenerational Outside Activities from 10-11am

April 3rd: Sunday School Inside (masks required) from 10:15-11am

April 10th: Palm Processional & Palm Sunday Activities Outside from 10-11am

Weather permitting, we'll also plan more outdoor adventures - watch your emails!

MIDDLE SCHOOL & HIGH SCHOOL YOUTH GROUP

Throughout March, we'll be meeting each week from 4-5:30pm.

April 3rd - as it sits between many of our students' spring break - we will NOT have Youth Group.

**& MINNEHAHA YOUTH PARENT MEETING:
SUNDAY, 6th March 4-5:30PM**



CAMPING SUNDAY - FEBRUARY 27TH SUMMER CAMP REGISTRATION OPEN

On February 27th at 10am, we'll be outside for Worship and Camping Sunday Activities, with information about our various programs and registration available. We hope you'll join us!



TRANSITION BACK TO THE EDUCATION WING



February saw us heading back inside for Sunday School. After twenty-three months, it was good to be back in the rooms, and kids, teachers, and parents all have enjoyed getting to explore familiar and new spaces.

Thanks to all those volunteers who helped get the rooms prepared and welcoming for participants and to our volunteers who have had to be so very flexible as we continue to shift plans to adapt to Covid.

At this point, we continue to require masking inside!

Minnehaha UMC Summer Camps



Registration for 2022 Camps Now Open!

www.minnehaha.org

Compassion Camp: Changing the World With LovingKindness An Evening Intergenerational Vacation Bible School

When: Monday, June 20-Thursdays, June 23 from 6-7:30pm

Where: Minnehaha Side Lawn

Who: Children with their Families, and People of All ages welcome & encouraged

(This is a family-style event and children must be accompanied by an adult to attend. Picnic dinners will also be available beforehand..)

Squirrels & Others: Making a Musical, Saving the Animals Minnehaha Music & Drama Camp

When: Monday, August 1-Friday, August 5th from 9-3pm

Evening Performance on Friday, August 5th

Where: Minnehaha Side Lawn

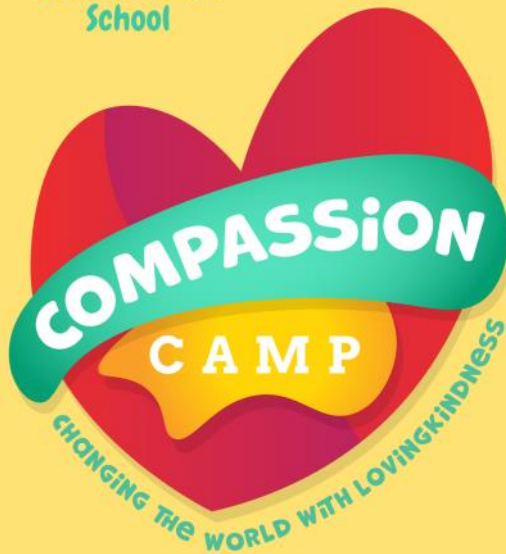
Who: Kids who have completed kindergarten through eighth grade

**An all-ages Family Camping Weekend is in the works -
watch for more information coming soon!**



MINNEHAHA UMC INVITES YOU
TO JOIN US FOR:

**Intergenerational
Vacation Bible
School**



**Monday, 20th June - Thursday, 23 June
6-7:30pm**

Side Lawn, Minnehaha UMC

MORE INFORMATION & REGISTRATION AT
WWW.MINNEHAHA.ORG



SQUIRRELS & OTHERS: MAKING A MUSICAL, SAVING THE ANIMALS



MINNEHAHA MUSIC & DRAMA CAMP

When: Monday, Aug 1st-Friday, Aug. 5th
from 9am-3pm

Evening performance on Friday the 5th

Who: Kids who've completed Kind.-8th Grade

Where: At Minnehaha UMC

Cost: \$100/participant

Register at www.minnehaha.org
scholarships available



A frozen Youth outing this winter



Looking for a Sleep-Away Camp Experience?

Many from the Minnehaha Community Participate
in our Conference Summer Camp Program: Camp Minnesota

We encourage you to join us!
REGISTRATION IS OPEN NOW AT www.campminnesota.org

Teddy Bear Camp - Session 2

For 6-9 year olds
July 14-16 at Camp Koronis
A great first sleep away camp!



Trailblazers Camp - Session 1

For 8-12 year olds
July 10-13 at Camp Koronis

Pathways Camp - Session 2

For 9-13 year olds
June 26-July 1 at Camp Koronis



Youth who have completed 5th-12th
grade are also invited for a Boundary
Waters Base Camp Experience at
Kowakan.

This will be July 12-16th.
We'll be heading up together as a group.
and registration is available at
www.minnehaha.org



Camp Minnesota
Minnesota
Annual Conference
of the United Methodist Church
Camping & Retreats Ministries



Adult Faith Forums

Adult Faith Forums begin again on Sunday, March 6 from 10:15-11 in the Fellowship Hall. Led by Marshall Cook, the initial series, entitled “Confronting the Controversies,” will feature video remarks by Adam Hamilton, the senior pastor of the United Methodist Church of the Resurrection (located in Leawood, Kansas and the largest United Methodist congregation in the world), and will encourage us to approach controversial issues both civilly and with our faith in hand.

- March 6 – The Separation of Church and State
- March 13 – Creation and Evolution in the Public Schools
- March 20 – The Death Penalty
- March 27 – Euthanasia
- April 3 – Prayer in Public Schools
- April 10 – no faith forum due to palm processional
- April 17 – no faith forum – Easter!

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taize service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us on March 11 and April 8 for a time of renewal. The service is also livestreamed, so you can worship through your screen, wherever you are, either in real time or anytime after.

Personal Dignity Items Drive

Every year during Lent, we do a special drive for the Food Shelf. This year, like many of our past years, we are collecting personal dignity items for the Food Shelf. These items, like toothpaste, bar soap, shampoo, etc., are not provided to the Food Shelf from Second Harvest Heartland, and so they are in short supply. Items that are the most popular at the Food Shelf are feminine hygiene supplies and diapers.



Lenten Devotional

We will be utilizing a devotional during Lent (which begins on March 2 this year) that features both the scripture readings for the week and Mary Oliver's poetry. Copies of the devotional are available at church; if you are unable to pick up a copy and you would like one, please contact the office and we can mail one to you. All of Mary Oliver's poems in the devotional can be found in her book, *Devotions*. They can also be found online. If you need access to the poems a different way, please let Pastor Becky know.

Lenten Series – Soul Reset

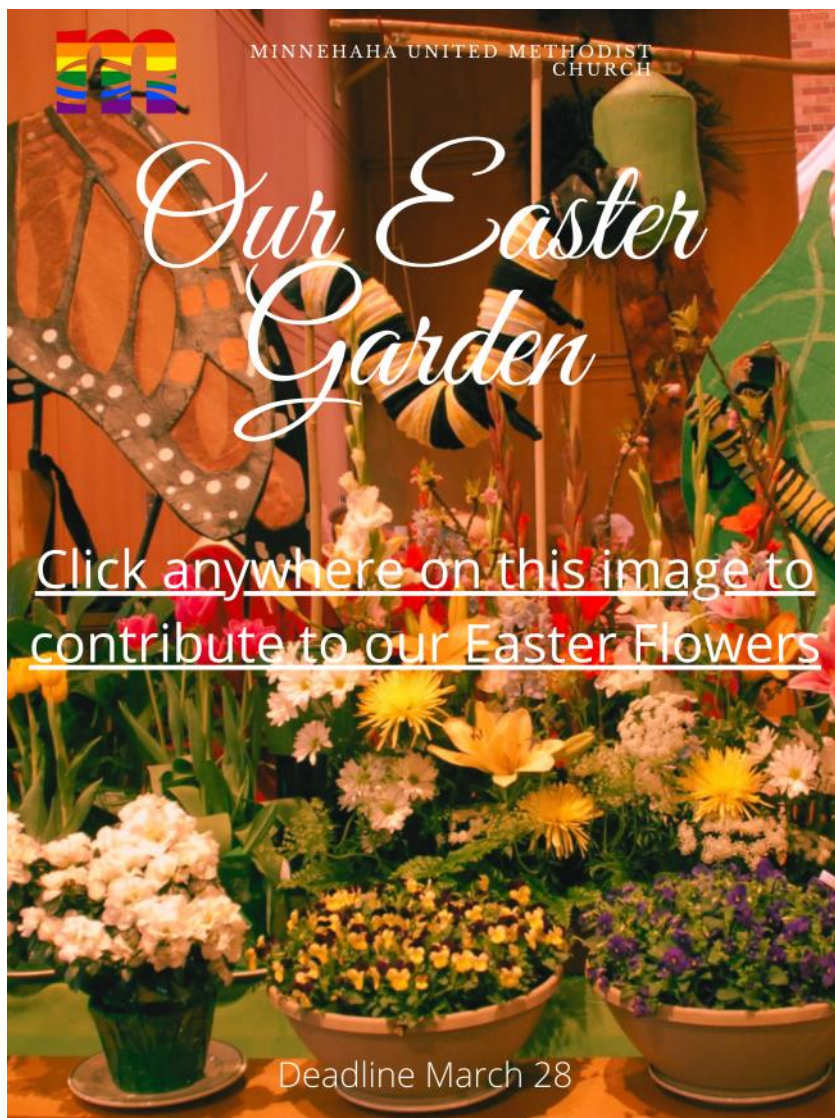
Our Adult Study in Lent will be *Soul Reset* created by Junius Dotson. Rev. Dotson advocated for racial justice, as well as for us to take the time to feed our souls so that we can do the work God is calling us to. Soul Reset will meet on zoom on Monday evenings, 6:30-7:30 and on Tuesday mornings, 10:15-11:15 in hybrid form. You will need the book, and to read chapter 1 before the first class. The class will begin on March 7 & 8. If you need a book and cannot pick one up at church, please let Becky know.

Ash Wednesday

Lent begins on Wednesday, March 2 this year, and we will be starting our Lenten observance with an Ash Wednesday service at 6:30 p.m. If you've never been to an Ash Wednesday service before, this is a more solemn service that includes ashes made from the burning of palms from last year's Palm Sunday. We "impose" the ashes as a reminder of how sometimes even our best intentions can go awry, and as a reminder of our own mortality. All ages are invited to participate in the service. For those who want to have ashes imposed, but are unable to come to the service, Pastor Becky will

Readers Needed for Good Friday

For Good Friday (April 17), we will be utilizing 14 readings during the worship service. Each reading comes from the Gospel According to Luke and each reader extinguishes a candle after the reading. If you would like to be one of the readers, please talk to Becky and she'll find a reading for you. Thanks!



Other Lenten Study Options

In addition to the Lenten study offered at Minnehaha, there are two other options available to you via zoom.

- Join Hopeful EarthKeepers (the Minnesota UMC group working on environmental justice) to learn to write a meaningful land acknowledgement statement while taking part in a transformative journey following the book "On This Spirit Walk" by Henrietta Mann & Anita Phillips.

Minnehaha is working on creating a land acknowledgement statement; if you are interested in being part of that team, this would be an excellent way to participate.

The study will be offered from 5-7 p.m. on Sundays and Thursdays, March 20, 24, 27, 31, April 3 & 7.

Please register at: <https://www.minnesotaucmc.org/eventdetail/land-acknowledgement-journey-15862717>

- Rev. Dana Neuhauser, Racial Justice Coordinator for the Minnesota Annual Conference of the United Methodist Church is leading an online study based on the book *The Church Cracked Open: Destruction, Decline, and New Hope for Beloved Community*.

It will be from 6:30-8:00 p.m. on Tuesday evenings, March 15, 22, 29, and April 5.

Please register at: <https://www.minnesotaucmc.org/eventdetail/book-study-the-church-cracked-open-destruction-decline-and-new-hope-for-beloved-community-15848189>

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend (and a mask)! We'll be offering food on March 26.

The Auction is Coming!

Our "services" auction in 2020 was a great success! And, we are going to do it again this spring, after Easter, when we have the option to hold it outside if necessary. You may want to start assessing your talents and see what you might be willing to offer at that time. Do you make awesome cookies? Want to offer a dozen a month to some lucky bidder? How about breakfast for 6? Or maybe you have a camping trailer you'd be willing to lend out for a week. Or a cabin. Are you a bird expert? Know your mushrooms? You could offer a guided tour. The possibilities abound! You can let Sue Claude know if you have something you are willing to offer.

United Methodist Women

Your UMW continues to serve a dinner at Simpson Shelter with a variety of volunteers from Minnehaha UMC once a month. They are in need of serving other nights along with serving lunch and dinner as they are keeping their overnight guests during the day time. If you are interested in helping out more than once a month, please let me know. The servers in January were Charlene and Craig Johnson, Kevin Korell, Sarah Emrick, John Darlington, me and Paula Barton. They currently serve 60 people and have enjoyed our meals using turkey and food items from the Minneharvest. We also served on Monday, Feb. 28.

Watch for UMW Sunday on March 20. We annually honor folks in our congregation or community who have been in service to Minnehaha UMC along with sharing how we use the money we raise.



Your UMW is part of an international UMW that meets every four years for a General Assembly. The 2022 Assembly, "Turn it Up!", delayed from 2020, will be occurring virtually on May 20-22 (also live in Orlando, FL). We are hoping to attend it together virtually, viewing the worship services, breakout groups, and speakers on a screen at church, if possible. (Doesn't everything seem to have that worry?) There will be a fee for participating which we will share later. You can also go to the General Assembly on your own virtually or live in Florida. Several of us have attended before and were excited to meet with women from around the world. Please check it out at assembly2022.org or unitedmethodistwomen/generalassembly2022.org.

We are very pleased to share experiences, hopes, and dreams with the women of Minnehaha UMC; know you are important and we care as sisters.

Peace, Maureen Trepp, *UMW President*

Museum Field Trip

Let's get together physically (we hope) to view and discuss two interesting new exhibits at the Hennepin History Museum. On Saturday, March 19, we have reserved space for folks to go to the museum at 2303 3rd Ave. So. at 3:00 to view "Human Toll: A Public History of 35W" and "Separate Not Equal: The Hale Field Pairing". Both exhibits speaking out about racial injustices right in our backyard. We have gotten a reduced rate of \$8/adults, \$5/students/seniors. We can meet at Minnehaha UMC to carpool as parking is difficult or you can meet us there. We'd also like to suggest going over to nearby Eat Street (Nicollet Ave.) afterwards to eat at one of the many ethnic restaurants and discuss our impressions. You can let Maureen Trepp know you are coming by March 12-maureentrepp@yahoo.com or (cell) 612-387-2520. Who knows if this will come to pass but there's always hope!



United
Methodist
Women

HENNEPIN
HISTORY MUSEUM



Racial Justice at Minnehaha

The Minnehaha Racial Justice Team, formed a year ago, has just begun meeting monthly to help us move more concretely into acts of racial justice. We prepared a statement of intent over the summer. Included in that statement is the belief that racism and racial inequity are specific problems in our society, that there is no easy fix, and that we want to take intentional steps to eliminate inequities. Church Council approved the statement of intent in August, and it was also approved at the Annual Meeting in January. The full Statement of Racial Reconciling Intent is included below:

As participants in the Racial Reconciling Movement, the Minnehaha Racial Justice Team believes and commits to the following on behalf of the congregation:

As stated in Article V of the Constitution of the United Methodist Church:

The United Methodist Church proclaims the value of each person as a unique child of God and commits itself to the healing and wholeness of all persons.

The UMC recognizes that the sin of racism has been destructive to its unity throughout its history. Racism continues to cause painful division and marginalization.

The UMC shall confront and seek to eliminate racism, whether in organizations or in individuals, in every facet of its life and in society at large.

The UMC shall work collaboratively with others to address concerns that threaten the cause of racial justice at all times and in all places.

We have found to be true:

- Jesus' ministry focused on lifting up the most marginalized
- Racism and racial inequity are specific problems in our society
- Failing to listen to the voices and stories of all people is a loss to all of us
- There is often a discrepancy between our values and how we live our lives
- There is no easy answer or quick fix

We want to:

- Assert the right of all people to freedom from legal, economic and social discrimination
- Condemn all overt and covert forms of intolerance, being especially sensitive to media stereotyping
- Break down the established social patterns of the racist value system
- Eliminate racism in our society: individual, cultural, institutional, and systemic

We commit to:

- Be courageous even when faced by the magnitude of the task, by guilt or shame, or by the perceived powerlessness of a single person
- Take intentional steps to eliminate inequities
- Build relationships through on-going efforts
- Raise awareness, speak up and take action, both as a congregation and as individuals
- Provide access to resources and provide action-oriented education to our congregation
- Assess our progress in these commitments on a regular basis

We will:

- Call upon our congregation to pray, seek, and work for the elimination of racism
- Conduct, and repeat annually, a Racial/Ethnic Awareness audit
- Work with a coach to set goals for progress
- Engage in vital conversations in groups and worship
- Transform this Statement of Intent for our congregation to a Covenant Statement made by our congregation

We focused on the specific issue of slavery and racism in January and February through a sermon series on racism and adult studies during the week utilizing the 1619 podcast. These topics and the Racial Justice Team's recommendations for other readings brought us to our commitment to prepare a Land Acknowledgement statement since Minnehaha UMC is

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MUMC Financial Position

At the Annual Meeting on January 23rd, attendees voted to accept the church's financial statements for 2021 and approved the proposed budget for 2022. The Finance committee wants to make sure everyone has access to this information even if you did not attend the Annual Meeting.

General Fund	
Statement of Revenues and Expenditures	
12/31/2021	
Revenues	2021
Contributions	\$ 422,015
Building Usage (NET)	21,179
Fund Raising (NET)	1,387
Other Income	70,488
Total Revenues	515,069
Expenditures	
Interfund Loan	7,055
Financial Expenses	1,587
Conference Apportionments	48,556
Staff Parish Relations	280,098
Trustees	78,117
Office Expenses	13,290
Programming and Ministry	10,969
Total Expenditures	439,672
Net increase/(decrease)	\$ 75,397
Net Assets - January 1, 2020	\$ 23,727
Net Assets - Ending balance	\$ 99,123

This information to the left gives a summary of the 2021 revenues and expenses in the operating fund ('General Fund') of the church. We outperformed our budget last year for three main reasons:

1) The government loan we received as part of the COVID stimulus plan (PPP Loan) was fully forgiven which contributed ~\$48,000 of income.

2) We received a generous bequest, \$25,000 of which went to our General Fund.

3) Contributions exceeded budget by \$27,000. This was primarily due to strong giving in December of 2021 from members who started paying their pledges from 2022.

2021 expenditures tracked closely to budget. This resulted in a net increase of \$75,000 in the assets of the General Fund compared to a budgeted decrease of \$33,000. This puts us into a good financial position going into 2022!

The budget for 2022 is similar to the budget approved for 2021. We are not expecting to repeat the 'one-time' events listed above that led to the revenue

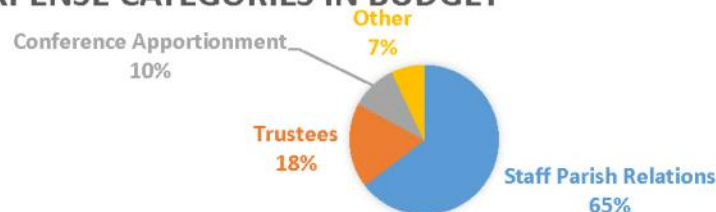
being significantly higher in 2021. Expenses have increased slightly due to higher utility prices and a budgeted one-time bonus for staff, as they did not receive a compensation increase in 2021. As is typical with almost every organization, staff expenses make up the majority of the MUMC budget as shown in the chart below.

Given all of this information, we are budgeting for expenditures to exceed revenues. The cushion we have from 2021 allows this right now but at this rate we will have used up the surplus in 3-4 years. This means that over the next few years we will need to work together to solve this issue on a longer-term basis. Please let one of our Finance Committee members know if you have any questions or if you have any ideas related to helping us move to a more balanced budget over the longer-term. Reach us at

Finance@minnehaha.org.

General Fund	
2022 Budget	
Revenues	2022
Contributions	\$ 385,000
Building Usage (NET)	20,000
Fund Raising (NET)	7,500
Other Income	18,935
Total Revenues	431,435
Expenditures	
Interfund Transfers	1,648
Financial Expenses	1,590
Conference Apportionments	45,803
Staff Parish Relations	296,610
Trustees	84,502
Office Expenses	13,142
Programming and Ministry	15,850
Total Expenditures	459,145
Net increase/(decrease)	\$ (27,710)
Expected General Fund Balance 12/31/22	\$ 71,413

MAJOR EXPENSE CATEGORIES IN BUDGET



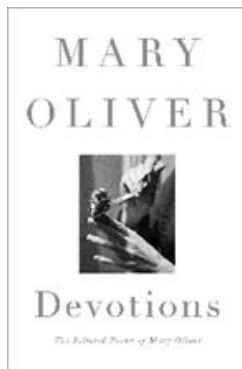


Poetry

I love Mary Oliver's poetry. I might have said that a time or two before, but I really do. Her writing seems to touch something deep in my soul – showing how God is present in a summer day, how the natural world can reflect its Creator, and how amazement at something as simple as a blade of grass or migrating geese is one of the ways we praise God.

The Salt Collective created a Lenten series that utilizes some of Mary Oliver's poems, and we'll be using their materials this year for worship and for our Lenten devotional. I used this devotional last year and loved it so much that Martha and I decided to keep reading Mary Oliver's poems from her book, *Devotions*, after Easter. We read two a day during breakfast and finished the last poem just in time to begin this year's Advent Devotional. It was a wonderful way to start the

"...amazement at something as simple as a blade of grass ... is one of the ways we praise God"



day, and my copy of the poetry book now has a smear of jelly, some toast crumbs, and dirt from our camping trip all worked into its cover.

I know that not everyone will find Oliver's poetry speaking to their soul, just like not everyone loves the 23rd Psalm, or not everyone thinks murder mysteries are fun reading. But give it a try this year. And, if it leaves you empty, then I encourage you to find something that does feed your soul and dwell on that during Lent and beyond. We all need to fill our souls so that we can be the people God calls us to be.

In Joy,
Becky

(Continued from page 9)

built on land once belonging to the Dakota people, but was later taken and colonized by our ancestors. In addition to the statement that will honor the space we occupy, we are planning a banner and signage outside the church.

At this time, the Racial Justice Team also committed to the creation of a spiritual fund as "reparations" for the many spirituals we have known and sung for years. Because there is no known composer, no royalties have been paid when we sing them in a service. On Martin Luther King Sunday, we sang or hummed five spirituals that came to us from enslaved people who had settled here but who had no royalties for their songs. With \$200.00 from a special offering taken on MLK Sunday, the Racial Justice Team will send the money collected to the Capri Theatre in North Minneapolis. Their mission statement says "Together with the PCYC (Plymouth Christian Youth Center) "enrich the skills, prospects and spirit of North Minneapolis area youth and adults, in partnership with families and communities." With money from the Spiritual Fund, the Racial Justice Team anticipates choosing a recipient each year. People can contribute to this fund at any time.

Minnehaha Racial Justice Team has just begun the difficult tasks for racial reconciling. We will continue to address Race Reconciling on behalf of the Minnehaha congregation and to "Transform this Statement of Intent for our congregation to a Covenant Statement made by our congregation."



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3/22

Visit us online!
www.minnehaha.org

Lent begins March 2

See inside for :

- **Ash Wednesday**
- **Lenten Studies**
- **Dignity Drive**
- **Easter Flowers**

